

# CSI v10 — Navigating the User Interface

Study notes from the Infor official training workbook (107 pages)

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## Why this guide matters

This is an **end-user training workbook**, not developer documentation. It teaches someone how to *use* the CSI/SyteLine application day-to-day — opening forms, finding records, editing data, printing, exporting. No IDOs, no WinStudio, no C# here.

Even so, this is essential groundwork: before you customize a form, you need to understand exactly how a regular user experiences it. A lot of the vocabulary here (forms, collections, filter-in-place, grid view, detail view) will come up constantly once you move into development work.

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## 1. Core concepts: forms, records, fields, collections

The system is **database-oriented**. Everything you do happens through a **form** — the window through which you interact with the database.

- **Form** — a window dedicated to a business task (entering a PO, checking a PO's status, receiving items). Different forms exist even for related tasks on the same data.
- **Record** — one complete set of related data (e.g., everything about item SPX-90).
- **Field** — a single piece of information within a record (e.g., the item's description).
- **Collection** — a group of related records retrieved together (e.g., "all purchase orders from Vendor X").

### Types of forms:

| Form type | What it does                                                 |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Multiview | Two-pane window (grid + detail), separated by a splitter bar |
| Query     | Used to search for and retrieve specific records             |

| Form type            | What it does                                                                     |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grid-only            | All data shown/edited in a spreadsheet-like grid                                 |
| Detail-only          | Shows details for a single record only                                           |
| Report               | Generates reports                                                                |
| Utilities/Activities | Batch-process multiple records at once (purge, update status, post transactions) |

## 2. User interface elements

- **The Explorer** — hierarchical tree (like Windows Explorer) for browsing/opening forms. Top-level folders: **My Folders**, **Master Explorer**, **Public Folders**, **User Folders**.
  - Inside Master Explorer: **All Forms** (alphabetical, everything), **Modules** (grouped by business area — Customer, Material, Finance, etc.), **Optional Modules** (APM, Industry Packs, Localization, QCS, Service...), **Roles** (grouped by job function — Sales, Material Planning, etc.)
- **Menu bar** — same folders, browsable as drop-down menus at the top of the window.
- **Main toolbar** — icons for common actions (save, new, delete, refresh...). Hover for tooltip.
- **Context (right-click) menus** — heavily used throughout the app for quick actions on a field/value.

### Finding and opening forms — four methods

1. **Select Form dialog** (**Ctrl+O**) — search by **caption** (display name) or **internal system name** (Hungarian-notation prefix). Type partial text in "All containing" to filter.
2. **Menu bar**
3. **Explorer** — best when you don't know the form name but know its purpose/module/role.
4. **Linking features** — buttons, edit-menu links, and Actions-menu lists that jump to a *related* form. A linked form shows **(Linked)** in its title bar.

## 3. Form views

A multiview form has two panes joined by a **splitter bar**:

- **Grid view** — left pane, tabular row/column layout of the whole collection.
- **Detail view** — right pane, shows full detail of the single record currently selected in the grid.
- **Dual view** — both panes shown at once (the default).

You can toggle either pane on/off (**View > Hide/Show 1st/2nd Splitter Pane**, or **Ctrl+1** / **Ctrl+2** on Smart Client).

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## 4. Form modes — the most important concept in this guide

Every form is in one of three modes:

| Mode           | What it means                                                                                                 |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Filter</b>  | Fields are blank; you're entering search/filter criteria. Nothing else can be done here.                      |
| <b>Refresh</b> | Data is loaded and visible; you can view, add, edit, delete. <b>You must be in this mode to change data.</b>  |
| <b>New</b>     | Looks like Refresh, but you're creating a new record. Identifiable by a <b>blue star</b> next to the new row. |

To go from Filter mode → Refresh mode: run the filter (**F4**, or click Filter In Place, or Execute in Place).

Row label indicators (appear in grid view, left column)

| Symbol         | Meaning                                   |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Blue arrow     | Saved record, currently selected          |
| (blank)        | Saved record, not selected                |
| Blue star      | New record, no errors, not yet saved      |
| Orange diamond | Modified record, no errors, not yet saved |
| Red X          | Marked for deletion (not yet committed)   |

| Symbol                | Meaning                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Red exclamation point | Has a validation error — must be fixed before saving |

## 5. Retrieving data — filter-in-place vs. queries

The app has three layers: **database** → **middleware** → **presentation** (what you see on screen). Opening a form *copies* data from the database to your desktop — nothing changes in the real database until you save.

### Filter-in-place (simple, quick searches)

- Temporary, cannot be saved.
- Supports operators: `<`, `>`, `<>/!=`
- Supports wildcards: `*` (text/date), `NULL`
- **Does NOT support AND/OR logic** — for that, use a query.
- **Data cap defaults to 200 records.** Use "Get more rows" to pull the next batch.

### Queries (complex searches)

- Opened via `Actions > Filter > By Query` or `Ctrl+Q`.
- Two tabs: **Primary Criteria** (joined by AND only) and **Additional Criteria** (build custom AND/OR clauses).
- A query **clause** = field name + operator + value (e.g., `State = NY`).
- Supports operators: `LIKE` (= wildcard search), `=`, `<`, `>`, `<>`
- Supports special values: `*`, `NULL`, `?` (prompts you for a value when applying a saved query), `CURDATE(n)` (today ± n days — e.g. `CURDATE(-1)` = yesterday).
- **Queries can be saved** for reuse (filter-in-place criteria cannot).
- Some forms ship with **default/predefined queries** already built in (e.g., "Filter Due Next 7 Days" on Customer Order Lines).

## 6. Working with grids

- **Resize, reorder, hide columns** via right-click → **Edit Grid Columns** (the "Edit Grid Column Visibility and Order" dialog).
- **Sort**: double-click a column header (toggles ascending/descending), or use the **Sort dialog** (`Edit > Sort Collection`) for more control — lets you pick the property, ascending/descending, and case sensitivity.

- Sorting is **character-based** even for fields that look numeric — worth remembering since it affects ordering of codes like #222 vs 222 vs XL-64.

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## 7. Adding, editing, deleting records

### Field colors/symbols when adding a record

| Symbol         | Meaning                                                                                       |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Red asterisk   | Required                                                                                      |
| Green asterisk | Required, but system auto-generates if left blank (type ? + prefix to trigger auto-numbering) |
| White          | Optional                                                                                      |
| Gray           | Read-only                                                                                     |

### Drop-down lists — two types

- **Business data lists** — built from real records maintained in another form (e.g., Items).
- **Option lists** — built into the system, fixed set of choices.

You can **filter** a drop-down (type partial text + wildcard), **Find** a specific value (Ctrl+F), or **Add** a brand-new value directly from the field (only works on business data lists, not option lists).

### Saving

- Save current record only: Actions > Save Current
- Save the whole collection: Ctrl+S / Save toolbar button / Actions > Save

### Copying a record

Actions > Copy duplicates the selected record as a starting point for a new one — useful for repetitive data entry. Auto-numbered fields either regenerate or duplicate depending on whether they're manually editable.

### Validation / error checking

Validation runs when you: navigate away from a record, try to save, or click Actions > Validate. You **cannot save until all errors are corrected**. The system walks you field-by-field through each error.

## Undo (before saving only)

- **F5** / Refresh → undoes changes to **all** records (re-pulls from DB)
- **Ctrl+F5** / Refresh Current → undoes changes to **current** record only
- Close + cancel changes → discards everything, closes form
- Delete the new record outright

Once saved, changes are permanent — you can tell something is still undoable if a row label indicator (star/diamond/X/exclamation) is still showing.

## Deleting

Marks the record with a red X; it's only actually removed from the database **after you save**.

## Find & Replace in a collection

- **Find Value in Collection** — searches forward from the current record (does not loop back).
  - **Replace Value in Collection** — bulk-updates a field across many records at once. Supports an "All Values" override and a Yes/No/Yes-to-All confirmation flow. Does **not** support wildcards or comparison operators — values are treated literally.
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## 8. Notes

Two attachment scopes:

- **Object notes** — attached to one specific record. Can print on reports.
- **Class notes** — attached to *every* record in a collection at once. Reusable-only, never print on reports.

Two reuse types:

- **System notes** — created once, usable/visible by *any* user, printable.
- **User notes** — usable/visible only by the person who created them, not printable.

Notes are also tagged **Internal** or **External** — this tag controls whether they show up on a given report's output, depending on which print options are selected.

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## 9. Printing & reports

A report typically has: filter/range parameters → **Preview** (check it first) → **Print** (send to output).

Output formats include PDF, CSV, Excel, Excel (Open XML), HTML/MHTML/TIFF (SSRS only), Word, Word (Open XML), or directly to a Printer.

Report defaults are configured in two places: the **Intranets** form (system-wide defaults) and the **Report Options** form (per-user/report/device defaults).

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## 10. Activities and Utilities

These are **batch-processing forms** — they apply one operation across many records at once (e.g., marking a range of job operations "Complete" in one shot instead of editing each individually).

Two processing styles:

- **Preview and Commit** — trial run first (nothing written to DB), then flip to Commit + Process to actually apply.
- **Process only** — no trial run; it runs directly against the database.

Two execution styles:

- **Immediate** — a dialog confirms completion right away.
- **Background queued** — dialog says "Task Submitted"; you verify completion later in the **Background Task History** form (check the **Completed** field — not just **Started**).

Batch error behavior differs by mode: **record-by-record** processing keeps whatever succeeded before the error; **whole-batch** processing rolls back everything if any record fails.

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## 11. Exporting & moving data to Excel

- **Export to File** — saves a collection as **.csv** (comma-separated) or **.txt** (tab-separated) to a chosen path. Choose "current collection only" or "unlimited query" (pulls everything matching the filter directly from the DB, ignoring the desktop data cap).

- **To Excel** (`Actions > To Excel`) — one-click export + auto-open in Excel; saves as `[FormName][sequence].csv` in My Documents.
  - **Manual copy/paste** — select cells/rows/columns/whole grid in the form → `Ctrl+C` → paste into Excel. Works the same way in reverse (paste from Excel into a grid), with care needed: column order in the spreadsheet must exactly match the grid's visible column order, and you should batch large pastes to avoid memory issues.
  - **Important Smart-Client-only limitation:** most of this granular row/column/cell copy-paste functionality is **not available in the Web Client** — only the whole-collection "To Excel" / "select-all-and-copy" methods work there.
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## 12. Smart Client vs. Web Client — key differences (Appendix C)

This matters because your team will tell you which client the end users (and possibly you) are working in.

### Not available in Web Client at all:

- Page Setup, Print Preview, Print, Export to File, Workspaces (Form menu)
- Activate Next Collection, Home Cursor, Warnings (View menu)
- Calculator form
- Browse buttons (e.g., License Management — must paste file contents instead of browsing)
- Cut/Copy/Paste in right-click menu
- The "auto-insert" row in grids
- Granular Excel copy-paste (rows/columns/cells individually)

### Behaves differently in Web Client:

- Tabbing inside a grid exits the grid instead of moving within it (accessibility difference)
  - Timer events: 5-second minimum (vs. 1 second in Smart Client) and only fire while the form has focus
  - Status bar is mostly hidden, flashes only on URL changes
  - Locale/currency/date formatting is overridden by the app, not the browser
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## 13. Useful appendices for later reference

- **Appendix A** — sample learner/training login credentials (only relevant to the training environment, not real systems).



- **Appendix B** — how to show/hide toolbar icons ([View > User Preferences > Runtime Layout tab](#)). Note: Web UI users can't do this themselves — IT manages it globally for the Desktop UI.
  - **Appendix D — Workspaces**: a saved group of forms that all open together with one command ([Form > Workspaces](#)). Not available in Web Client. You can't save a filter as part of a workspace.
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## Quick keyboard shortcut cheat-sheet (Smart Client)

| Action                       | Shortcut                                          |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Open Select Form dialog      | <a href="#">Ctrl+O</a>                            |
| Close form                   | <a href="#">Ctrl+F4</a>                           |
| Next / previous record       | <a href="#">F8 / F7</a>                           |
| New record                   | <a href="#">Ctrl+N</a>                            |
| Save                         | <a href="#">Ctrl+S</a>                            |
| Copy / Cut / Paste / Undo    | <a href="#">Ctrl+C / Ctrl+X / Ctrl+V / Ctrl+Z</a> |
| Delete record                | <a href="#">Ctrl+D</a>                            |
| Begin filter-in-place        | <a href="#">F4</a> (also runs it)                 |
| Cancel filter-in-place       | <a href="#">F3</a>                                |
| Clear filter-in-place        | <a href="#">F5</a>                                |
| Refresh current record       | <a href="#">Ctrl+F5</a>                           |
| Open query form              | <a href="#">Ctrl+Q</a>                            |
| Toggle design mode           | <a href="#">Ctrl+E</a>                            |
| Find value for current field | <a href="#">Ctrl+F</a>                            |

*(Web Client supports a smaller subset of these — see Appendix C above for what's missing.)*

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